PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	Oral health assessment of older adults living in Long-Term Care Facilities by non-dental professionals: A systematic review protocol of instruments
AUTHORS	Rodrigues, Lorrany; Vettore, Mario Vianna; Figueiredo, Isadora; Sampaio, Aline; Ferreira, Raquel Conceição

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Gerd Göstemeyer Charite Universitatsmedizin Berlin, Department for Operative and Preventive Dentistry
REVIEW RETURNED	17-Apr-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	This is a protocol for a systematic review aimed at assessing the validity of instruments to assess the oral health in older people. The topic of this review is important and interesting. I have just some minor comments which could improve the protocol. Introduction: • P6, line 16: the abbreviation “InterRAI” should be written out in brackets like for the other tools Methods • P8, line 9: articles should not only be identified by the search, but also by screening the reference lists of included articles • P9, line 41: It should be specified which risk of bias assessment toll will be used • P10, line 39: “…that the pooled is of high quality.” A word is missing here.

REVIEWER	Ryan Ruff New York University College of Dentistry, Epidemiology & Health Promotion
REVIEW RETURNED	23-Apr-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	I was asked to perform a statistical review of this proposal. The authors propose to conduct a systematic review of instruments used to assess oral health of the institutionalized geriatric population. The primary methods following the standard systematic review protocol are to perform (1) an evaluation of the psychometric properties of instruments using COSMIN and (2) an evaluation of quality using GRADE. While I have not used COSMIN before, I have used GRADE and familiarized myself with the COSMIN checklist. COSMIN requires an evaluation (qualitatively) of the psychometric properties of the instrument, e.g., construct validity, criterion validity, CFA, etc. The authors hace done an acceptable job explaining how they will use COSMIN.

	Beyond this, there are no statistical methods proposed in the paper that I can evaluate. I do not know if this is a limitation or not. Regardless, the statistical review is unnecessary as no statistics are proposed. As an aside, can aging be considered a "phenomenon"?

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Reviewer: 1
Dr. Gerd Göstemeyer, Charite Universitatsmedizin Berlin
Comments to the Author: This is a protocol for a systematic review aimed at assessing the validity of instruments to assess the oral health in older people. The topic of this review is important and interesting. I have just some minor comments which could improve the protocol.
Response: We appreciate your comments and hope that our review will improve the protocol.

Introduction:
- **P6, line 16: the abbreviation "InterRAI" should be written out in brackets like for the other tools**

Methods
Response: We added the meaning of ohr-InterRAI, and the abbreviation was shown in parentheses.

- **P8, line 9: articles should not only be identified by the search, but also by screening the reference lists of included articles**

Response: The last phrase of the 2nd paragraph (search strategy section) mentioned that "The reference lists of included articles will also be screened."

- **P9, line 41: It should be specified which risk of bias assessment toll will be used**

Response: The COSMIN Risk of Bias checklist will be used. This information has been added in the 1st and 2nd paragraph of the Assessment of methodological quality section.

- **P10, line 39: "…that the pooled is of high quality." A word is missing here.**

The sentence was rephrased to: "The starting point is always the assumption that the obtained pooled result if of "High" quality level".

Reviewer: 2
Dr. Ryan Ruff, New York University College of Dentistry, New York University College of Global Public Health
Comments to the Author:
I was asked to perform a statistical review of this proposal. The authors propose to conduct a systematic review of instruments used to assess oral health of the institutionalized geriatric population. The primary methods following the standard systematic review protocol are to perform (1) an evaluation of the psychometric properties of instruments using COSMIN and (2) an evaluation of quality using GRADE. While I have not used COSMIN before, I have used GRADE and familiarized myself with the COSMIN checklist. COSMIN requires an evaluation (qualitatively) of the psychometric properties of the instrument, e.g., construct validity, criterion validity, CFA, etc. The authors hace done an acceptable job explaining how they will use COSMIN. Beyond this, there are no statistical methods proposed in the paper that I can evaluate. I do not know if this is a limitation or not. Regardless, the statistical review is unnecessary as no statistics are proposed.
Response: We are grateful for the reading of the manuscript and we confirm that a qualitative analysis will be carried out according to criteria proposed by COSMIN.

As an aside, can aging be considered a "phenomenon"?
Response: The term "phenomenon" was replaced by "process".